

Practice Exercises on Must be True Questions

1.

Environmentalist: The commissioner of the Fish and Game Authority would have the public believe that increases in the number of marine fish caught demonstrate that this resource is no longer endangered. This is a specious argument, as unsound as it would be to assert that the ever-increasing rate at which rain forests are being cut down demonstrates a lack of danger to that resource. The real cause of the increased fish-catch is a greater efficiency in using technologies that deplete resources.

The environmentalist's statements, if true, best support which of the following as a conclusion?

- (A) The use of technology is the reason for the increasing encroachment of people on nature.
- (B) It is possible to determine how many fish are in the sea in some way other than by catching fish.
- (C) The proportion of marine fish that are caught is as high as the proportion of rain forest trees that are cut down each year.
- (D) Modern technologies waste resources by catching inedible fish.
- (E) Marine fish continue to be an endangered resource.

2.

The fewer restrictions there are on the advertising of legal services, the more lawyers there are who advertise their services, and the lawyers who advertise a specific service usually charge less for that service than the lawyers who do not advertise. Therefore, if the state removes any of its current restrictions, such as the one against advertisements that do not specify fee arrangements, overall consumer legal costs will be lower than if the state retains its current restrictions.

If the statements above are true, which of the following must be true?

- (A) Some lawyers who now advertise will charge more for specific services if they do not have to specify fee arrangements in the advertisements.
- (B) More consumers will use legal services if there are fewer restrictions on the advertising of legal services.
- (C) If the restriction against advertisements that do not specify fee arrangements is removed, more lawyers will advertise their services.
- (D) If more lawyers advertise lower prices for specific services, some lawyers who do not advertise will also charge less than they currently charge for those services.
- (E) If the only restrictions on the advertising of legal services were those that apply to every type of advertising, most lawyers would advertise their services.

3.

Most of the new cars that Regis Motors sold last year were purchased by residents of Blomenville. Regis Motors sold more new cars last year than it did in any previous year. Still, most new cars purchased by Blomenville residents last year were not purchased from Regis Motors.

If the statements above are true, which one of the following must also be true?

- (A) Regis Motors sold more new cars to residents of Blomenville last year than they had in any previous year.
- (B) The total number of new cars purchased by residents of Blomenville was greater last year than it was in any previous year.
- (C) A car retailer other than Regis Motors sold the most new cars to residents of Blomenville last year.
- (D) The number of new cars purchased last year by residents of Blomenville is greater than the number of new cars sold by Regis Motors.
- (E) Regis Motors' share of the new car market in Blomenville last year increased over its share the year before.

4.

On average, cats fed canned cat food eat fewer ounces of food per day than do cats fed dry cat food; the canned food contains more calories per ounce than does the dry food. Nonetheless, feeding a cat canned cat food typically costs more per day than does feeding it dry cat food.

Which one of the following is most strongly supported by the information above?

- (A) On average, cats fed canned cat food eat more calories per day than do cats fed dry cat food.
- (B) Typically, cats are fed either canned cat food or dry cat food, or both.
- (C) How much it costs to feed a cat a given kind of food depends only on how many calories per ounce that food contains.
- (D) On average, it costs no less to feed a cat that eats fewer ounces of food per day than it does to feed a cat that eats more ounces of food per day.
- (E) Canned cat food typically costs more per ounce than does dry cat food.

5.

When expert witnesses give testimony, jurors often do not understand the technical information and thereby are in no position to evaluate such testimony. Although expert witnesses on opposite sides often make conflicting claims, the expert witnesses on both sides frequently seem competent, leaving the jury unable to assess the reliability of their testimonies.

The statements above, if true, most strongly support which one of the following?

- (A) There should be limits placed on how much technical information can be considered by both sides in preparing a legal case.
- (B) Jury decisions in cases involving expert witness testimonies are not always determined by the reliability of those testimonies.
- (C) Jurors who understand the technical information presented in a case can usually assess its legal implications accurately.
- (D) Jury members should generally be selected on the basis of their technical expertise.
- (E) Expert witnesses who testify on opposite sides in legal cases are likely to agree in their evaluations of technical claims.